Pupil studio resources & worksheet — One change, named before you make it

Pathway: TRACK · Week 5 Part 1 · Big question: How does naming one specific compositional change before touching the page lead to stronger refinement?

Arrival check

Why do experienced artists stop and name ONE specific change out loud or in writing before they start 'fixing' a nearly finished piece?

[ ] Naming the single change stops you overworking the page and ruining the parts that already work

[ ] It directs your hand to the exact edge or shadow that needs attention

[ ] It gives you a clear 'before and after' story for your studio log

Starter visual cues

Refinement option A (Contour lock): Restating the central subject's outer edge with varied brush-pen line weight.

Refinement option B (Highlight lift): Adding crisp white gouache or chalk accents along the light-facing edge.

Refinement option C (Tonal deepen): Deepening core shadows on the focal motif so it steps forward from the pattern.

Rule: Name your change on your log card BEFORE you pick up the tool.

Vote: What is the biggest danger of adding lots of random extra marks all over a finished artwork without a plan?

Studio practice planner

Name your targeted change before picking up your studio tool.

Shapes/Focus: Target: outer contour weight, Target: figure-ground halo, Target: core shadow depth, Target: highlight accents

Tools/Methods: Black brush-pen restatement, Opaque white gouache/chalk, Deep 6B/indigo shadow glaze, Warm amber pastel rim

Exit ticket

Why do we stop working as soon as our one or two named refinements are complete?

[ ] To keep the artwork fresh and high-contrast without overworking or muddying the surface

[ ] Because we are not allowed to finish

[ ] Because pens only last one minute